ASTERIX THE GAUL

Details **Originally published** Pilote, #1-38, October 1959 – July 1960 **Publisher** Dargaud (Orion Children's Books UK) **Writer** René Goscinny **Artist** Albert Uderzo **Collected in** Asterix The Gaul **Available digitally** Amazon

The creations of Goscinny and Uderzo have left their mark on generations of young comics readers, combining a bit of history, a bit of magic and a lot of fun for a consistently entertaining and laugh-out-loud funny long-running series. It all began back in 1959 in the pages of *Pilote* (the first run was later collected into *Asterix The Gaul*), as one small Gaulish village holds out against Julius Caesar's Roman invasion.

The first volume, which introduces our diminutive hero and his friend Obelix, shows that this resistance is (partly) due to a magic potion created by local druid Getafix, who is promptly abducted by a Roman centurion, and it's up to Asterix to get him back before their secret is uncovered.

The combination of Goscinny and Uderzo's two talents was consistently brilliant, showcasing a rare subversive wit, heart, and a great sense of the absurd. The village is packed with memorable characters, from the menhir-carrying, super-powered Obelix to the infuriated chieftain Vercingetorix. There are more than 30 adventures to read (26 of which are written by Goscinny), and we can't recommend them highly enough.





